

RETAIL MANAGEMENT

# GROUP PROJECT PORTFOLIO

*Cover It: An E-Commerce Marketing Plan and Storefront Launch*

## **Cover It Team**

Claudia Sophia Toscano Gonzalez • Arshdeep Kohli • Sumeet Telgote  
Hafsa Maomi Barsha

MKTG 4430-01 — Sheena van Dyk  
Thompson Rivers University  
Winter 2024

## Contents

|   |                                                       |   |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------|---|
| 1 | Marketing Plan: Cover It E-Commerce Retail Store..... | 3 |
| 2 | E-Commerce Storefront and Presentation.....           | 8 |

# 1 Marketing Plan: Cover It E-Commerce Retail Store

---

*Assignment 1 — Marketing Plan (10%) — a business-style marketing plan for Cover It, an e-commerce store selling phone and laptop cases, built on Shopify as the first phase of a planned retail expansion. Co-authored with Claudia Sophia Toscano Gonzalez, Arshdeep Kohli, and Hafsa Maomi Barsha.*

## Executive Summary

Cover It is an online e-commerce retail store that sells phone and laptop cases that seamlessly combine style, functionality, and above all, protection. It is based in British Columbia. There is high competition and price sensitivity in the market, but what sets Cover It apart is its commitment to individuality and high quality, backed by military-grade protection and no-cut-corners materials.

On the e-commerce retail store, the plan is to bring secure payment gateways and an easy-to-use online web page. Promotion will be distributed mainly through social media, and the revenue model is set up quarterly. At Cover It, the store does not just sell cases — it offers products that reflect a customer's personal style, whether a minimalist design or a bold statement piece.

## Mission Statement

At Cover It, the mission is to provide the highest standards of protection, quality, and precision in one product, whether customers select from ready-made designs or customize their own.

## Introduction / Product Services

Cover It is the ultimate destination for premium phone accessories, offering a wide range of products that make a customer's phone look and feel amazing — from skins and cases to screen protectors.

## Situational Analysis

The protective-case global market size is 26 billion USD in 2024 and is estimated to reach 33.70 billion USD by 2029, a CAGR of roughly 5.33% from 2024 to 2029. Reports show around 50% of online shoppers in Canada bought more items online in 2022 than in 2020, and more than a fifth said they started to avoid in-store shopping. Due to the nature of the industry, it is relatively unregulated apart from three major pieces of legislation: the Canada Consumer Product Safety Act, which prohibits the manufacture, import, advertising, or sale of consumer products that are a danger to human health or safety; the Consumer Packaging and Labelling Act, which regulates the packaging and labeling of consumer products including phone cases and screen protectors to prevent deception and ensure accurate information; and the Canadian Environmental Protection Act, which aims to protect the environment and human health from the potential impacts of substances and activities involved in production, distribution, and disposal.

## SWOT Analysis

### Strengths

**High-Quality Products:** the company's commitment to producing high-quality phone cases and screen protectors gives it a competitive edge, as quality materials, durability, and effective protection are key differentiators. **Innovative Designs:** unique and visually appealing designs can attract fashion-conscious consumers who seek both protection and style.

## Weaknesses

**Brand Awareness:** as a new entrant, the company lacks the brand recognition enjoyed by established competitors, so building brand awareness will be crucial. **Limited Product Range:** focusing solely on phone cases and screen protectors may mean missing out on potential revenue from related accessories or complementary products. **Distribution Channels:** as a new entrant, the lack of strong distribution networks and partnerships with retailers and online platforms is a significant weakness.

## Opportunities

**Growing Smartphone Market:** the increasing adoption of smartphones in Canada presents a significant opportunity to tap into an expanding market. **Customization Trends:** offering customizable cases, such as personalized designs and monograms, can attract consumers seeking unique products. **E-Commerce and Online Sales:** expanding online sales channels can help reach a wider audience, especially given the rise in e-commerce.

## Threats

**Competition:** established brands like ZAGG, OtterBox, Tech21, Spigen, and PureGear already dominate the market, so the company must differentiate itself to compete effectively. **Price Sensitivity:** consumers may compare prices and opt for well-known brands, so balancing quality and pricing will be critical.

| Particulars               | Otterbox          | Spigen                       | Zagg                 | PureGear       | Tech21             | Belkin                                             |
|---------------------------|-------------------|------------------------------|----------------------|----------------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Tier                      | Primary           | Primary                      | Primary              | Secondary      | Secondary          | Secondary                                          |
| Average Price             | 80                | 50                           | 65                   | 35             | 30                 | 70                                                 |
| Target Audience           | Women, 18-35      | Women, 18-35                 | Women, 18-35         | Women, 18-35   | Women, 18-35       | Women, 18-35                                       |
| Market Share              | Not Available     | Not Available                | Not Available        | Not Available  | Not Available      | Not Available                                      |
| Key Competitive Advantage | Lifetime Warranty | Strong Social Media Presence | 20ft Drop Protection | Affordability  | Market Penetration | Brand Equity "Apple's Official Accessorie Partner" |
| Marketing Strategy        | Offline Media     | Aggressive Online Presence   | Retail Partnerships  | Discount Brand | Discount Brand     | Brand Extension                                    |

*Competitive analysis grid — Otterbox, Spigen, Zagg, PureGear, Tech21, and Belkin by tier, average price, target audience, key competitive advantage, and marketing strategy*

The table above shows a competitive analysis using tier, average price, target audience, key competitive advantage, and marketing strategy as the comparison criteria.

## Target Market

**Tech Enthusiasts and Early Adopters:** Cover It appeals to tech-savvy individuals who appreciate customization and want to stand out; these early adopters seek unique products that enhance their devices. **Millennials and Gen Z:** sleek and modern designs resonate with younger consumers, who value personalization, aesthetics, and self-expression. **Gamers and Content Creators:** skins cater to gamers, streamers, and YouTubers who want to showcase their devices during gameplay or video creation. **Minimalists and Design Lovers:** clean, minimalist skins attract design-conscious individuals who prefer subtle customization over bulky cases. **Urban Professionals:** professional-looking skins appeal to urban workers who want to protect their devices without compromising style.

## Cover It Customer Persona

**Name:** Andy (gender-neutral, but more women-focused). **Age:** 28. **Occupation:** Graphic Designer. **Personality traits:** creative — appreciates unique designs and enjoys expressing creativity through personalization; tech-savvy — always up to date with the latest gadgets and trends; minimalistic — prefers sleek, understated aesthetics; detail-oriented — notices the smallest design elements; adventurous — enjoys exploring new customization options. **Values:** individuality, quality, and sustainability (eco-friendly).

options). Preferred communication style: concise, visually appealing content — infographics and short videos catch Andy's attention. Preferred channels: Instagram, YouTube, and tech forums. Emotional connection: Andy gets excited discovering new skin designs and enjoys sharing them with fellow tech enthusiasts.

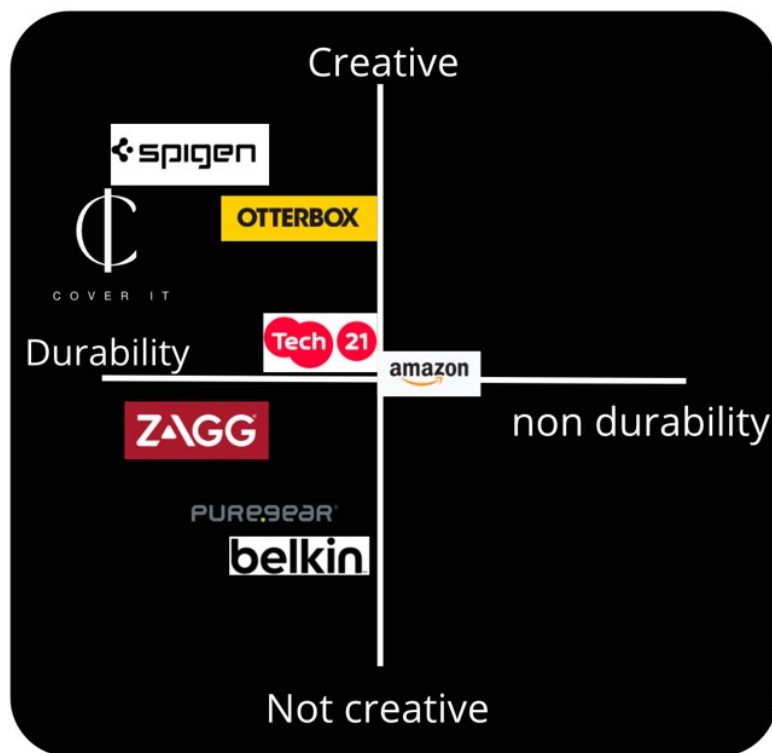
## Positioning

### Value Proposition

Cover It offers a diverse selection of phone and laptop cases that blend style, functionality, and above all, safeguard — whether customers select a ready-made design or customize their own, based in British Columbia.

### Differentiation Factor

What sets Cover It apart is its commitment to individuality — every case tells a story as unique as its owner. Cover It stands out by prioritizing military-grade protection and ensuring the safety of a customer's phone or computer.



Positioning map — durability vs. non-durability and creative vs. not creative, placing Cover It against Spigen, Otterbox, Tech21, Zagg, PureGear, Belkin, and Amazon

Cover It is looking to compete mainly with Otterbox and Spigen, the companies that provide higher durability, creativity, and a variety of different case designs.

## Marketing Strategy

### Marketing Objectives

1. Penetrate 10,000 retail outlets in British Columbia with branding through marketing materials appropriate to each outlet category by 2025. 2. Increase brand engagement by 75% across digital channels by 2025. 3. Achieve a market share of 5% by the end of 2025. 4. Build an active network of at least three major tech influencers. 5. Achieve a 95% positive review rating on Google and the company website.

### Product Merchandising Strategy

**Product line:** a diverse range of phone and laptop covers with trendy designs and patterns, a customizable design option for personalization, and a focus on durability, quality materials, and compatibility with various phone and laptop models. **Unique features:** military-grade protection, scratch-resistant and anti-fingerprint coatings, and innovative features like UV protection or antimicrobial properties. **Main brands:** an in-house brand for standard covers, collaborations with local artists or designers for exclusive collections, and a premium line with high-end materials and advanced technology.

**Vendors:** partnerships with reputable manufacturers specializing in phone cases and accessories, direct collaborations with phone brands for exclusive and branded cases, collaborations with local artists and designers for exclusive collections, and eco-friendly suppliers for sustainable materials. **Merchandise timing:** standard inventory updated quarterly, exclusive collections launched during key shopping seasons, customizable designs available year-round, seasonal collections for summer, winter, and holidays, regular updates to the fashion collection to align with trends, and periodic limited-edition releases for exclusivity.

**Process and technologies:** an easy-to-use online customization tool, secure payment gateways, an e-commerce platform for online sales, 3D modeling and customization tools for personalized cases, augmented reality for virtual try-ons, and a responsive website and mobile app for a seamless user experience. **Distribution channels:** an omnichannel approach including the company's own online store and third-party platforms, collaborations with electronic retailers both online and physical, partnerships with tech accessory stores, an online e-commerce retail store, social media, and affiliate marketers — collaborating with influencers and bloggers in the tech and fashion niche, offering affiliate programs with commission structures, and providing influencers with exclusive discount codes for their audience.

**Pricing:** competitive pricing with a reasonable markup, a premium line with a higher markup to reflect quality and exclusivity, and discounts for bulk purchases and bundle deals. **Promotion:** engaging visuals featuring product highlights, behind-the-scenes content, and customer testimonials on Instagram, Facebook, and Pinterest, regular contests, giveaways, and user-generated content campaigns, content showcasing product versatility and durability, influencer collaborations for unboxing and review videos, and targeted Facebook and Instagram ads. **Customer relationship management:** collecting customer feedback and reviews, a loyalty program offering discounts and exclusive designs, and regular engagement through newsletters with updates and special offers.

### Product Line Depth and Width

**Product width** spans phone cases catering to various brands and models and screen protectors compatible with different devices. **Product depth** includes, for phone cases: slim fit, rugged armor, leather wallet, clear, customizable designer, battery charging, waterproof, impact resistance, fashion collection, sports edition, eco-friendly, luxury collection, kids and cartoon-themed, glow-in-the-dark, and limited edition

cases; and for screen protectors: tempered glass, matte finish, privacy, anti-glare, blue light blocking, curved edge, full coverage, nano liquid, flexible film, diamond hard, anti-fingerprint, anti-scratch, colored, mirror finish, and customizable protectors.

### Key Performance Indicators

Number of retail outlets: track the expansion of Cover It's presence in retail outlets across British Columbia, monitor new partnerships established each month, analyze the distribution of outlets across regions to ensure comprehensive coverage, and evaluate each outlet's performance based on sales data and customer feedback. Brand engagement: measure engagement across social media, the company website, email newsletters, and online forums, track likes, shares, comments, clicks, and website traffic, monitor follower and subscriber growth, and analyze the effectiveness of content strategies, campaigns, and promotions.

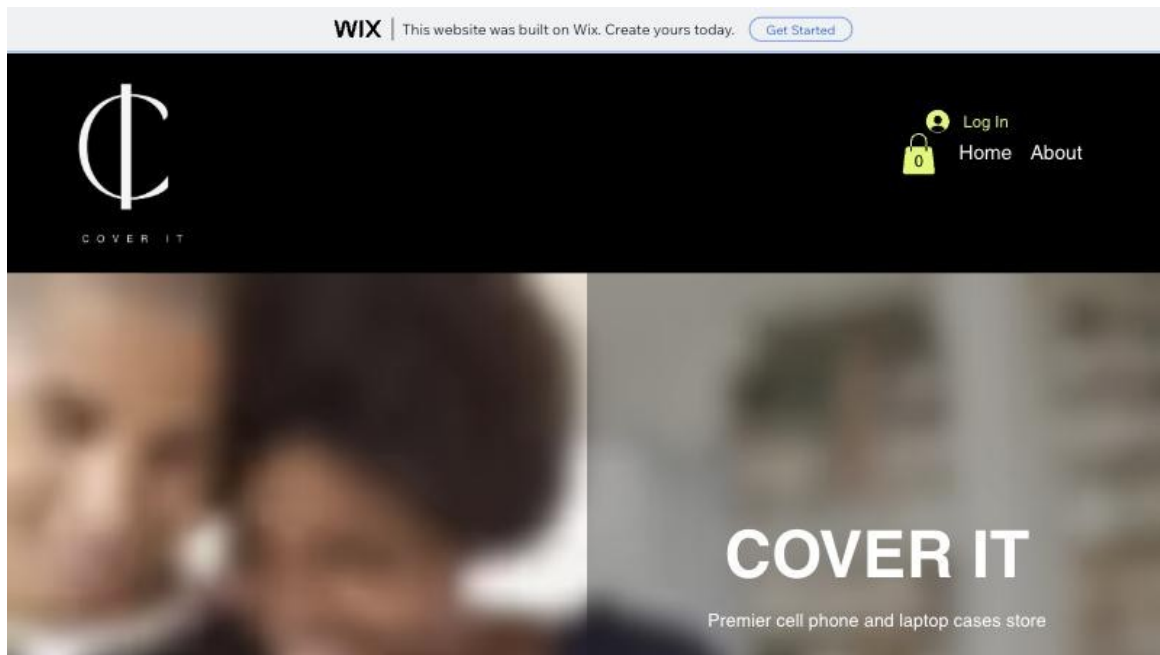
Market share: monitor Cover It's share of the phone and laptop case market in British Columbia, compare it with competitors, analyze sales data and market research for trends and opportunities, and track changes in market share over time. Influencer network: identify and build relationships with key influencers in the tech and lifestyle space, monitor partnership performance in reach, engagement, and conversion, measure the impact on brand awareness and sales, and seek influencer feedback to improve partnerships. Customer reviews: monitor and respond to reviews on Google, the website, and social media, track overall rating and sentiment, identify trends in feedback to inform product development and marketing, and encourage satisfied customers to leave positive reviews while addressing negative feedback promptly.

Financial information: projected monthly revenue of \$100,000 from phone and laptop case sales, a quarterly revenue growth rate of 15%, and an annual revenue projection of \$1,800,000. Cost of goods sold is estimated at \$5 per unit for materials, \$3 for manufacturing and labor, and \$2 for distribution and shipping, for a total COGS of \$10 per unit, with quarterly COGS projected at roughly 30% of revenue. Planned marketing expenses include a \$20,000 monthly digital advertising budget, a \$15,000 quarterly influencer partnership budget, and a \$50,000 annual budget for promotional materials and events, for total quarterly marketing expenses of \$70,000, or about 20% of revenue. The resulting gross profit margin is projected at \$10 per unit (50%), with quarterly gross profit of \$100,000 and an annual projection of \$1,800,000. Return on investment is calculated by comparing net profit generated to total campaign cost — for example, a \$20,000 digital advertising campaign generating \$50,000 in additional revenue would represent a 150% ROI.

## 2 E-Commerce Storefront and Presentation

*Assignment 2 — E-Commerce Store and Presentation (20%) — building out the Cover It storefront from the marketing plan above and presenting it to the class.*

Working from the Assignment 1 marketing plan, the team built Cover It's e-commerce storefront and presented it to the class. The live store (built on Wix rather than Shopify) is published at [telgotesumeet.wixsite.com/cover-it-1](https://telgotesumeet.wixsite.com/cover-it-1) and showcases the Cover It brand with a styled homepage and a nine-product catalog spanning the case lines described in the marketing plan.



*Cover It storefront — homepage hero*

### Product Catalog

- Rugged Armor Case — \$29.99
- Personalized Designer Case — \$29.99
- Slim Fit Phone/Laptop Case — \$19.99
- Rugged Armor Clear Case — \$19.99
- Customizable Slim Fit Designer Phone Case — \$19.99
- Rugged Armor Shockproof Phone Case — \$29.99
- Matte Black Slim Fit Phone Case — \$19.99
- Rugged Armor Laptop Sleeve — \$29.99
- Clear Laptop Case — \$29.99